Fiscal Year:	FY 2008	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 05/20/2008
PI Name:	Bingham, Gail E Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Validating Vegetable Production Unit Plants, Protocols, Procedures and Requirements Using Currently Existing Flight Resources		
Division Name:	Space Biology		
Program/Discipline:	SPACE BIOLOGY		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	SPACE BIOLOGY--Advanced human support technologies		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	(1) Cell & Molecular Biology (2) Microbiology (3) Plant Biology		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	(1) Developmental Biology		
Space Biology Special Category:	(1) Bioregenerative Life Support		
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PI Organization Type:	UNIVERSITY	**Phone:**	435-797-4320
Organization Name:	Utah State University		
PI Address 1:	Utah State University Research Foundaton		
PI Address 2:	Space Dynamics Laboratory, 1695 North Research Park Way		
PI Web Page:			
City:	North Logan	**State:**	UT
Zip Code:	84341	**Congressional District:**	1
Comments:			
Project Type:	Flight	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2003 Space Biology 03-OBPR-01
Start Date:	01/01/2004	**End Date:**	07/31/2011
No. of Post Docs:	0	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	0
No. of PhD Candidates:	1	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	0
No. of Master's Candidates:	2	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	0
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	3	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA KSC
Contact Monitor:		**Contact Phone:**	
Contact Email:			
Flight Program:	ISS		
Flight Assignment:	NOTE: per PI, project transferred to KSC management (5/2008 report) NOTE: Per PI, end date is 7/31/2011; changed 8/24/2007 NOTE: corrected end date to 07/31/2007 per PI (1/07)		
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:			
COI Name (Institution):	Garland, Jay (Life Support Group, Kennedy Space Center) Bates, Scott (Department of Psychology, Utah State University) Bugbee, Bruce (Department of Plants, Soils and Biometeorology, Utah State University)		
Grant/Contract No.:	NNJ04HG03G		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			

Task Description:	The primary objectives of the Lada VPU P3R experiments include advancing the Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of our plant species and support equipment, developing a Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Point (HACCP) plan for use of plant materials grown in the cabin, and measuring the non-nutritional value of various plants and plant presentation approaches. These studies will be carried out in both flight and ground studies. Plants Identify, flight-qualify and optimize the support requirements for the vegetable and flower plant varieties that are most likely to be utilized to meet flight crew needs (wants) and that fit within the hardware resource limitations that exist on the ISS and will exist on the CEV. This work will validate the technology readiness level of our available cultural practices to provide reliable, low-cost, stimulating products for crew well being. What plants can tolerate existing cabin ethylene levels without adding the cost of ethylene scrubbers? Will seed-producing plants be genetically stable over the 500 to 600 day mission? Food Safety Identify the threat levels and validate the procedures and protocols required to allow US astronauts to eat space-grown vegetables. Determine how to implement these procedures to maximize crew mental health benefits with minimum mission costs. What procedures and hardware need to be in place to assure crew health on a long flight? Non-Nutritional Value Quantify the mass value that should be assigned to the non-nutritional effects of plants in a spacecraft cabin. How much vegetable yield is required for a measurable boost to crew response under the isolation and stress of long-term space missions? How should this stress-relieving resource be presented (open or closed, single crew tended or multiple access) to maximize its value? Is this resource of value to all crew members, or is there a subset that prize the experience much more highly? The objectives will provide the data necessary to qualify plant products for authorized consumption on the ISS by US crewmembers. The Lada hardware and the cooperative agreement with IBMP have been shown to provide ideal, continuing opportunity to investigate many of the plant, procedure, protocol, and food safety requirement (P3R) issues associated with meeting crew livability requirements. The Lada VPU P3R uses existing hardware on the ISS (Lada) and leverages our cooperative agreement with the Institute of Biomedical Problems (IBMP) in Moscow.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	Plants not only provide food, but for many they provide comfort and relaxation – a diversion from the stress of required activities. In the past, NASA has researched the option of including a Vegetable Production Unit (VPU) as a component of the life support system of their long-duration space flight vehicles. A previous road mapping exercise identified priority 1 and 2 Critical Path Risks for which plant materials and growth support activities could provide solutions. For at least some people plants provide significant non-nutritional benefit to long-duration crews. These values are currently based only on anecdotal and untested observations that need verification. Part of the benefit may be a small fresh food source, which makes food safety issues important. The VPU study addresses these Critical Path risks, and in the process of monitoring microbial accumulations around Lada also contributes to crew health risk knowledge and reduction. Understanding the oxygen to water balance in the root zone applies not just in space, but in terrestrial agriculture as well. There is an acute need to optimize the efficiency of water use in agriculture, and leach-free experiments can be conducted only in space. This project will facilitate the understanding of how to better irrigate (precision watering) and fertilize different plants. The experiment also has considerable environmental implications as the ISS cabin is the ultimate setting for practicing recycling of plant, soil, water, and atmospheric resources.
Task Progress:	The Lada VPU P3R project was awarded under the NASA Research Announcement 03-OBPR-01-0000-0111. The project has been assigned to the Applied Technology Flight Program Research Integration Office (KT-B) at Kennedy Space Center (KSC) for sample return development and integration. The most significant milestone of 2007 was receiving a contract extension to continue this project through July of 2011. The project team has now begun submitting the required documentation to be manifest on Increments 19 and 20. During the formulation phase of this study, we successfully built a world-class team and established the foundation agreements to allow US university, industry and NASA scientists to work together with IBMP and Moscow University scientists to conduct the research required to meet the mutually agreed upon objectives of this effort. Lada continues to provide valuable plant material on the ISS. Our Russian colleagues have continued to work closely with us and to provide opportunities for us to join in their research. For example, we have been invited to participate in the planned Mars 500-Day Chamber Study. The Lada VPU P3R team has successfully demonstrated its ability to meet or exceed all of the program objectives and is positioned to develop the data required to allow mission and systems designers to understand the optimum functionality and mass value of living plants in the crew environment during long-term space flight activities.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 03/08/2018)
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bugbee B. "Electric lighting in controlled environments: misperceptions about the importance of spectral quality." Invited talk at Symposium on Past, Present, and Future of Research in Controlled Environments, at the ASA-CSSA-SSSA annual meeting 2007, New Orleans, LA, November 2007. Am. Soc Agronomy. 2007 abstracts, 126P. , Nov-2007
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Chard J, Bugbee B. "Techniques for maintaining and quantifying drought stress in containerized plants." Invited talk at Symposium on Ethylene Suppression in Crop Yield Formation, symposium on Physiological Responses to Irrigation, Drought, Salinity, Cold, and Hypoxia, at ASA-CSSA-SSSA annual meeting, New Orleans, LA, November 2007. Am. Soc Agronomy. abstract #641, 2007; 63P. , Nov-2007
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bugbee B. "Ethylene and Yield Physiology: Studies in Controlled environments." Invited talk at Symposium on Ethylene Suppression in Crop Yield Formation, at CO2 Crop Physiology and Metabolism symposium, ASA-CSSA-SSSA meeting, New Orleans, LA, November 2007. Am. Soc Agronomy. abstracts 2007; 105P. abstract #160-9. , Nov-2007

Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Heinse R, Jones S, Bingham GE, Bugbee B. "Optimizing Straticulate Plant-Growth Media for Improved Root Zone Performance and Management." ASA-CSSA-SSSA 2007 International Annual Meetings, New Orleans, LA, November 4-8, 2007. Agronomy abstracts, abstract #183-21, Am. Soc Agronomy, Madison, WI, 2007. p. 105. , Nov-2007
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Blonquist M, Bugbee B. "Beyond the crop water stress index: Applying biophysical principles to the measurement of plant stress measurement." ASA-CSSA-SSSA 2007 International Annual Meetings, New Orleans, LA, November 4-8, 2007. Agronomy Abstracts, abstract # 139-1, Am. Soc Agronomy, Madison, WI, 2007. p.88 , Nov-2007
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bugbee B, Blonquist M, Tanner B, Jones S. "Evaluation of new models of net radiometers." ASA-CSSA-SSSA 2007 International Annual Meetings, New Orleans, LA, November 4-8, 2007. Agronomy Abstracts, abstract # 139-20, Am. Soc Agronomy. 166P. 2007. , Nov-2007
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Romagnano J, Bugbee B. "Effect of 1-MCP in ethylene synthesis in intact plants." ASA-CSSA-SSSA annual meeting, New Orleans, LA, November 2007. Agronomy abstracts, Madison, WI, abstract #, Am. Soc Agronomy. 2007. 166P. , Nov-2007
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bingham GE, Bates SC, Gushin VI, Vinokhodova A, Marquit JD, Sychev VN. "Plants as Countermeasures for Humans Living in Isolated or Extreme Environments Such as Long Term Space Flight." American Society for Gravitational and Space Biology annual meeting, Moffett Field, CA, October 25-28, 2007. Gravitational and Space Biology 2007 Oct;21(1):32. , Oct-2007
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Bates SC, Gushin V, Bingham GE, Vinokhodova A, Marquit JD, Sychev VN. "Plants as Countermeasures: A review of the literature and application to habitation systems for humans living in isolated or extreme environments." submitted for publication, January 2008. , Jan-2008
Papers from Meeting Proceedings	Bates SC, Gushin VI, Marquit JD, Bingham GE, Sychev VN. "Plants as countermeasures in long-duration space missions: A review of the literature and research strategy." European Space Agency Workshop: Tools for Psychological Support during Exploration Missions to Mars and Moon, Noordwijk, The Netherlands, March 2007. ESA presentation 2007-03, Workshop: Tools for Psychological Support during Exploration Missions to Mars and Moon, Noordwijk, The Netherlands, 2007. , Mar-2007